India’s Five-Year Plans: Year, Theme, Motto and Description

Brief Revision Table

Plan	Year	Theme + Motto (combined)	Descriptive Focus: How / Why / Where / When
1st Plan	1951–56	Agriculture and irrigation — growth through agriculture	Launched soon after independence to increase food production, improve irrigation and support rural development.
2nd Plan	1956–61	Industrialization — rapid industrial growth	Focused on heavy industries, public sector growth and infrastructure to build a stronger industrial base.
3rd Plan	1961–66	Self-reliance and balanced growth — self-sufficiency	Aimed at reducing dependence on imports, strengthening basic industries and increasing agricultural output.
4th Plan	1969–74	Growth with stability — stability and growth	Addressed the need for stable growth during economic stress and gave importance to agriculture, industry and social justice.
5th Plan	1974–79	Poverty removal and self-reliance — removal of poverty	Emphasized employment, poverty reduction and rural development through programmes like NREP and the Minimum Needs Programme.
6th Plan	1980–85	Modernization and growth — growth with justice	Focused on modernization, technology, social welfare and rural development, especially for poor households.
7th Plan	1985–90	Food, employment and productivity — productivity and employment	Aimed at raising agricultural output, creating jobs and improving productivity in both rural and urban sectors.
8th Plan	1992–97	Human development and employment — human development	Emphasized education, health, employment and growth with social justice in the post-reform period.
9th Plan	1997–02	Growth with social justice — growth with equity	Focused on poverty alleviation, basic services, infrastructure and better access to education and health.
10th Plan	2002–07	Poverty reduction and employment — growth with employment	Aimed at faster economic growth, better employment opportunities and stronger social inclusion.
11th Plan	2007–12	Inclusive growth — faster and more inclusive growth	Concentrated on education, health, rural development, infrastructure and livelihood security for all.

Plan	Year	Theme + Motto (combined)	Descriptive Focus: How / Why / Where / When
12th Plan	2012–17	Faster, sustainable and more inclusive growth — sustainable development	Prioritized energy, infrastructure, skill development and balanced regional growth with sustainability in mind.

Quick Memory Points

- 1st Plan: Community Development Programme
- 2nd Plan: KVIC for rural industries
- 3rd Plan: IADP for food production
- 5th Plan: Minimum Needs Programme and NREP
- 11th Plan: MGNREGA and NRHM
- 12th Plan: NFSA for food security

Note

The 12th Five-Year Plan was the last official Five-Year Plan in India. After that, planning is guided by the NITI Aayog through long-term policy and development frameworks.